Day 4 (stop 1 of 2) - Black Walnut

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Niagara section · hike 5 · Short Hills Provincial Park

2.9 km / 1.8 mi	~0.9 h	1.4 km new	77 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

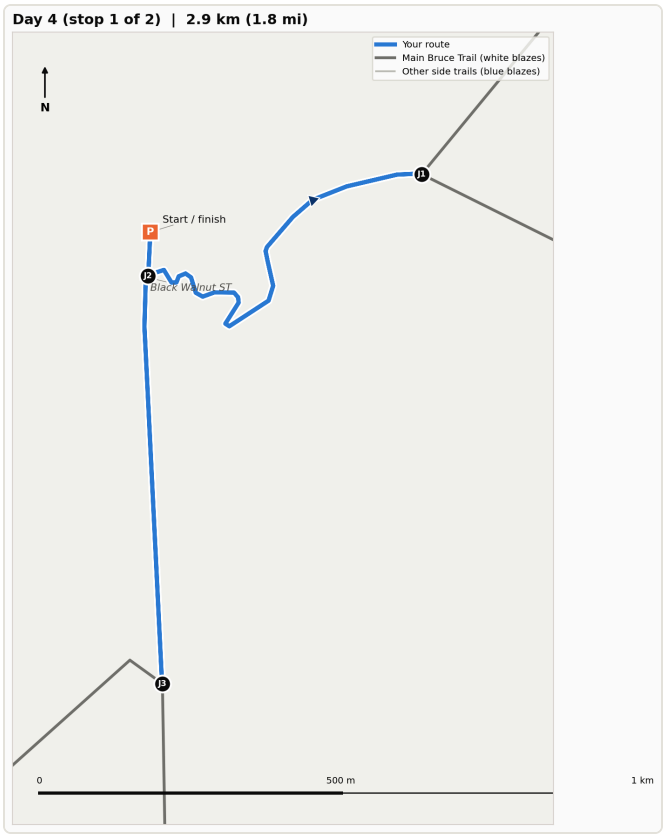
Park (P): Parking Area: Provides access to the Black Walnut Side Trail. Enter off of Pelham Rd. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day04a_hike005.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Black Walnut Side Trail (1.4 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 4 (7.4 mi of hiking, about 169 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 6, 5.5 mi from On the north side of Glendale Ave, 50 m east of Welland Canal.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Enter from Pelham Rd. Short Hills has three parking lots and few other facilities. There are toilets at the Pelham Rd lot. The park opens at sunrise and closes at dusk.
- **Black Walnut Side Trail:** A short out-and-back on a blue-blazed natural-surface side trail that crosses a low-lying area. The park's Black Walnut Trail runs alongside part of the Bruce Trail and is rated for steep hills and uneven ground. It is shared with cyclists and horse riders.
- **Closures and wet weather:** Storm and flood damage has closed parts of several park trails, including a section of the Black Walnut Trail. The park asks visitors to stay off trails when they are wet. Check current alerts before you go.
- **Dogs:** Ontario Parks requires dogs on a leash no longer than 2 m (6 ft). Waste bags and bins are at the park entrances.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Parking Area: Provides access to the Black Walnut Side Trail. Walk about 100 m to the trail. Head east on the blue-blazed Black Walnut Side Trail.
0.5	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.8	0.5	J1: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
1.5	0.9	J2: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Black Walnut Side Trail, heading south.
2.2	1.4	J3: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
2.9	1.8	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Friends of Short Hills Park and Ontario Parks.